

REFERME INVESTMENTS

Lessons Learned

Investment Analytics & Power BI Decision-Support Framework
Project Period: February - June 2026

Document Control	Details
Document ID	RMI-LL-001
Version	1.0
Purpose	Capture evidence-based lessons from the ReferMe Investments BA documentation/design work and convert them into reusable recommendations for future analytics initiatives.
Source Basis	Project requirements, gap analysis, KPI/scoring design, data-quality controls, RAID items, Power BI design, RTM and UAT planning.
Evidence Discipline	The source does not contain a historical retrospective with stakeholder quotes or measured post-project outcomes. Lessons below are therefore derived from documented project risks, gaps, controls and design decisions, not presented as stakeholder testimony.

1. Lessons Learned Summary

ID	Lesson	Evidence / Trigger	Future Recommendation
LL-01	Standardize evaluation criteria before comparing targets.	The AS-IS gap identified non-standard evaluation criteria and limited comparability.	Define a common KPI framework and normalization approach early, then validate segment-specific benchmarks where needed.
LL-02	A composite score must remain explainable.	The project risk register identifies that a composite score can hide a weak dimension.	Always expose dimension scores and underlying KPI evidence; define approved override rules rather than relying only on one overall score.
LL-03	Validate weights and thresholds before treating recommendations as business rules.	Scoring weights are proposed and recommendation/alert thresholds are not source-approved.	Separate configurable assumptions from approved rules and block final dependent UAT until approval is obtained.
LL-04	Data quality is part of decision confidence, not just technical housekeeping.	Incomplete source data is an explicit project risk and BR-10 requires data-quality visibility.	Make missing, invalid, duplicate and stale data visible to decision makers and reflect it in evaluation confidence.
LL-05	Design for traceability from the beginning.	The project requires BR → FR → US → UAT → Power BI traceability.	Maintain an RTM throughout delivery so changes can be impact-assessed and acceptance evidence can be tied back to requirements.
LL-06	Do not fabricate historical trends when history is unavailable.	Portfolio monitoring requires multiple periods and target data, while current source support is primarily snapshot-oriented.	Keep trend/target visuals future-ready or unavailable until sufficient real history and target data exists.
LL-07	Resolve definition inconsistencies explicitly.	The source contains a scoring-example inconsistency involving Recurring Revenue / Revenue Stability versus the 28-KPI catalogue.	Log the inconsistency, obtain a stakeholder decision and update all affected artifacts through change control.
LL-08	Separate BA design completion from production acceptance.	UAT scenarios exist, but executed results and formal sign-off are not established.	Close the documentation/design phase separately and never imply production readiness or UAT approval without evidence.

2. What Worked Well in the Project Design

- Organizing the investment framework into five dimensions gave the solution a clear business structure while preserving KPI-level detail.
- Using 28 defined KPIs created a common vocabulary across financial, operational, growth, customer and risk analysis.
- Linking requirements to user stories, UAT scenarios and Power BI outputs improved end-to-end traceability.
- Separating portfolio-level pages from selected-business detail pages kept decision questions distinct.
- Making data-quality visibility a business requirement reduced the risk of false confidence in incomplete evaluations.
- Treating scoring weights, thresholds and production architecture as configurable/TBD avoided presenting unapproved assumptions as facts.

3. Challenges / Areas Requiring Stronger Control

Area	Observed Challenge	Control for Future Projects
Scoring governance	Weights and thresholds require validation before final decision logic can be accepted.	Create a formal scoring-approval checkpoint before recommendation UAT.
Benchmark comparability	Different service-business models may not be fairly assessed by identical benchmarks.	Define segmentation/benchmark governance before normalization is finalized.
Data availability	The 28-KPI model depends on financial, operational and customer inputs that may be incomplete.	Perform source-data profiling and ownership confirmation early.
Historical monitoring	Trend and actual-vs-target reporting requires time-series and target data.	Confirm time grain, historical coverage and target ownership during data discovery.
Composite-score risk	A strong overall score can mask a weak risk or customer dimension.	Require score-driver drill-down and approved exception/override logic.
Definition consistency	Scoring examples and KPI catalogue can diverge if definitions evolve independently.	Maintain a single controlled KPI/scoring glossary and use change control.
Acceptance evidence	Designed UAT is not equivalent to executed UAT.	Maintain separate test-design, execution, defect and sign-off artifacts.

4. Lessons by BA Lifecycle Stage

Lifecycle Stage	Lesson to Reuse
Initiation	Define the business decision the analytics solution must support before selecting metrics or visuals.
Requirements	Write measurable BRs/FRs and acceptance criteria that can be traced to a decision output.
Process Analysis	Document AS-IS gaps before proposing TO-BE controls so the solution addresses a demonstrated need.
Data / KPI Analysis	Define KPI meaning, required inputs and data-quality controls before dashboard construction.
Scoring Design	Keep assumptions, approved rules and unresolved definitions visibly separate.
Solution Design	Use reusable selected-business filtering rather than hard-coded pages for individual targets.
Testing	Design boundary, reconciliation, data-quality and exception scenarios, not only happy-path visual checks.
Governance	Use RAID, decision/change logs and RTM updates to prevent silent changes.
Closure	State clearly what was designed, what was tested, what remains open and what evidence is still required.

5. Recommended Practices for the Next Iteration

- Run an early stakeholder workshop specifically for KPI definitions, scoring weights, normalization benchmarks and recommendation/alert thresholds.
- Profile actual source data before finalizing the semantic model so required KPI inputs, history and data-quality limitations are known.
- Create a controlled scoring configuration with versioned approvals rather than embedding unapproved constants into business logic.
- Use sensitivity testing to understand how changes in weights or benchmarks affect business ranking.
- Add explicit data-quality/confidence messaging to score-based decision views.
- Require reconciliation from dashboard summary → dimension score → KPI → source input for critical investment decisions.
- Execute UT-01 to UT-09 using approved test data and retain screenshots/calculation evidence, defects, retest results and formal acceptance.
- Carry unresolved production topics such as refresh, access/security, deployment and operational ownership into implementation governance.

6. Knowledge to Carry Forward

Knowledge Asset	Reusable Value
28-KPI Catalogue	Reusable starting framework for service-business investment evaluation, subject to benchmark validation.
Five-Dimension Model	Provides a consistent structure for financial, operational, growth, customer and risk analysis.
RTM	Demonstrates how to maintain requirement-to-test/report traceability.
Data Quality Rules	Provides a control pattern for missing, invalid, duplicate and stale inputs.
Scoring Methodology	Provides a configurable architecture for normalization, dimension scoring and overall scoring.
Power BI Requirements / Wireframes	Provides decision-question-driven dashboard structure.
UAT Pack	Provides repeatable business acceptance coverage across calculation, scoring, drill-down, trends, alerts and data quality.
RAID / Change Control	Provides governance for assumptions, unresolved decisions and controlled changes.